

H2O WaterBlock technology

Samsung and Apple will apparently be using the revolutionary new H2O WaterBlock technology, to completely waterproof their devices. <http://bit.ly/ydujMC>

Tizen's Future Gets Brighter

Samsung has announced they will be merging their home-grown mobile phone OS, bada, with Intel and Linux-partnered Tizen. <http://bit.ly/zmyWgK>

Delhi to get radiation tags for mobile phones

In a campaign against rising mobile radiation health concerns, the Delhi government has made it mandatory for all mobile phone manufacturers to display the radiation level emitted by their devices. The decision was made during a meeting between the state health department, Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR), Jawaharlal Nehru University and WHO in Delhi.

State Health Minister AK Walia, who presided over the meeting, also decided to put some restrictions on the mobile phone towers across Delhi, and urged Centre to draw up guidelines for mushrooming towers. Experts are now mulling over ways to incorporate the pro-



posed reforms from Delhi government into the present guidelines. Hopefully, the Centre will come up with pan-India guidelines soon. ■

RIM co-CEOs step down, COO steps in

Research in Motion announced a major change to their corporate hierarchy late yesterday, with COO Thorsten Heins replacing co-CEOs Jim Balsillie and Mike Lazaridis at the top as the new President and CEO of RIM. Balsillie and Lazaridis, apart from being co-CEOs, were also co-chairmen for nearly 20 years. Lazaridis will now become the vice-chairman, and Balsillie will remain a board member.

Speaking to the press, Balsillie and Lazaridis said that

the two suggested the leadership change to the board themselves, and that their current strategies will see continuity under Heins. They reassured shareholders that RIM's major projects for 2012 are still on track – specifically, the new PlayBook, the new QNX-based BlackBerry 10 operating system, and its platform lead device.

Heins clarified that there are no plans for putting RIM on sale, and that the company is hoping the new BB10 operating system is a big enough hit to even be licensed to other vendors. ■



Thorsten Heins

Android 4.0 ICS style guide phones

Google has written a style guide for Ice Cream Sandwich, hoping to help developers and device manufacturers create apps and user interfaces that are optimized for both tablets and smartphones. The style guide is called Android Design.

According to Android Developer Blog, Android Design is a “place to learn about principles, building blocks, and patterns for creating world-class Android user interfaces. Whether

you're a UI professional or a developer playing that role, these



docs show you how to make good design decisions, big and small.”

The recommendations supplied in the style guide are

optional, however, Google's intention is clear – it's trying to ensure that future Android apps and custom user interfaces from manufacturers will work well in terms of user experience, regardless of differences in display sizes and other hardware features. The aim is to make the Android

platform less fragmented as a whole, even within the unified Ice Cream Sandwich version of the operating system. ■

Nokia says 3G tariffs need corrections

Jasmeet Gandhi, Nokia India's head (services marketing) said that the 3G pricing in India has to be “corrected” to ensure that it is affordable for the lower-end consumers. “A lot of consumers in India want to future proof themselves in terms

of technology at the right price point. So when the pricing of 3G will be affordable, they will definitely go for it. And we have seen this happen in many categories”, Gandhi said. He also pointed out that the 3G technology was meant to “revolutionise” mobile experi-

ence by giving high-speed Internet and facilities such as video-calls, interactive gaming and mobile TV. The actual number of the 3G users is lesser than the expectations. Gandhi, however, turned down speculation that hefty prices of 3G services were hampering the

sales of smartphones. “Because people who buy smart phones at the high-end can afford 3G...It is not an issue. I think in smart phones segment 3G penetration is very decent.” he stated, adding Nokia is investing on 3G phones as well. ■